

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 564

By Campbell

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the beauty and importance of Nashville's Highland Rim Forest.

WHEREAS, Nashville's Highland Rim Forest is a vast expanse of woodland that cradles the city, forming a green crescent that is clearly visible from space; and

WHEREAS, more than simply a beautifully verdant backdrop to the city, the Highland Rim Forest provides critical stormwater management, improves water and air quality, mitigates urban heat-island effects, and sustains wildlife habitat and biodiversity; and

WHEREAS, Nashville's Highland Rim Forest is part of a larger physiographic region known as the Western Highland Rim, which the United States Department of Agriculture has designated as a Level IV ecoregion within Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, a significant portion of the Western Highland Rim encompasses approximately 127,000 acres of interconnected forest and wildlife habitat on the western flank of Nashville and Davidson County, forming a contiguous old-growth forested ecosystem recognized by state and federal agencies, including the Tennessee Department of Environment and Conservation, the United States Department of Agriculture, and the United States Fish and Wildlife Service, as well as regional conservation initiatives such as the Southeast Conservation Adaptation Strategy; and

WHEREAS, the forested Western Highland Rim lies above the Nashville Basin ecoregion, and a substantial portion of Nashville's metropolitan population resides downstream, making the highland forest's ecosystem services essential to Davidson County residents' quality of life; and

WHEREAS, the ecological significance of the Western Highland Rim forest has been formally recognized by the United States Fish and Wildlife Service and the State of Tennessee

and is reflected in long-range planning documents adopted by the Metropolitan Government of Nashville and Davidson County; and

WHEREAS, Nashville's designation as the "World's Largest Urban Forest," with over 100,000 acres of tree canopy within city limits, represents a unique natural asset, distinguishing Tennessee's capital as a leader in urban environmental stewardship; and

WHEREAS, within the vast urban forest are four stunning parks filled with the natural beauty of the Highland Rim: Beaman Park, Bells Bend Park, Radnor Lake State Park, and Warner Parks, which include both Percy and Edwin Warner Parks; these parks provide more than 4,700 acres of public outdoor recreation area with nearly 100 miles of hiking trails; and

WHEREAS, protective policies and land-use practices that preserve and sustainably manage Nashville's Highland Rim Forest are vital to safeguarding this beautiful, bountiful ecological region for the benefit of current and future generations; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commemorate Nashville's Highland Forest, not only for its inherent beauty but also for its essential contributions to the environmental health, quality of life, and economic vitality of Middle Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.